Automating Employee Data - ServiceNow Documentation

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1.Problem Statement

Your organization wants to regularly import a list of new employees with their details, such as Name, Email, Department, and Manager, from an external system. Once imported, when an Incident is assigned to an employee, the Incident form should automatically show the manager's email of the employee's department.

However, the Priority field on the Incident should default to a different value from the other child tables of the Task table because incidents often require urgent attention based on impact and urgency.

2.Objective

The objective of this scenario is to automate the import of employee data, display department manager information directly on incidents, and set a custom priority default for incidents to improve data accuracy, provide quick access to relevant information, and streamline the incident resolution process in ServiceNow.

3.Skills Required

- **Import Sets:** For ingesting external data into ServiceNow tables.
- **Dot Walking:** For accessing related fields from reference tables without scripting.
- **Dictionary Override:** For defining field properties specific to extended tables.

4.Milestone 1: Import Data from Data Source

Activity 1: Create Records in the Sheet

1. Open Google Sheets or Microsoft Excel.
2. Name the columns as: **name**, **email**, **department**, **manager**, and **manager's email**.
3. Enter some dummy records for testing purposes.
4. Save the sheet as: **employee data**.
5. Download the file as **.xlsx**, **.csv**, or **.xml** file.

Activity 2: Import Data

1 Open ServiceNow instance.

2 Click on **All** >> search for **Import Sets**.

3 Select **Load Data** under System Import Sets.

4. Select **Create table**.
5. Give the Import Set Table Name as: **import employee**.
6. Choose the file which we created in the spreadsheet (Activity 1).
7. Click Submit to upload the file.
8. Once the data is imported, click on **Personalized List** if needed to view columns.
9. Verify fields are added to the form.

Activity 3: Create Transform Map

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on **All** >> search for **Import Set**.
3. Select **Create Transform Map** under Import Sets.
4. Click on **New**.
5. Fill the following details to create a new transform map:
    6. **Name:** Employee data transform
    7. **Source Table:** import employee data (the table created in Activity 2)
    8. **Target Table:** User [sys_user]
9. Save the form.

Activity 4: Match Fields Using Mapping Assist

1. Scroll down on the created Transform Map form.
2. Click on **Auto Map Matching Fields**. (Some fields with identical names will match automatically).
3. Click on **Mapping Assist** to map remaining fields manually.

4. Select the fields you are mapping in the Staging Table (Source) and Target Table.
5. Select **Manager** in the Source table and add it to the map.
6. Select **Manager** field in the Target table and add it to the map.
7. Ensure all necessary fields (Name, Email, Department) are correctly mapped.
8. Click on the **Save** button.

Activity 5: Transform the Data

1. Click on **Transform** in the Related Links section of the Transform Map.
2. Select the map "Employee data transform" and click **Transform**.
3. Wait until the Data's transform state shows as **Completed**.
4. Click on the Import Set number (e.g., ISET0010003) under "Next steps" to review results.
5. Verify that the rows have been inserted into the User [sys_user] table successfully.

5.Milestone 2: Dot Walking

Activity 1: Display Department to the Assigned User

We need to display the Department, Manager, and Email information on the Incident form based on the "Assigned to" user, without creating redundant fields.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on **All** >> **Incident**.
3. Select **Create New** under Incidents.

4 Observe that there is no field like Department on the form, and Email/Manager fields are not visible by default.

5 We will use **Dot Walking** to retrieve this data without opening the user record.

6 Right-click on the form header (Context Menu) >> **Configure** >> **Form Layout**.

7 Locate the **Assigned to** field in the 'Available' slushbucket.

8 Click the generic **[+]** icon next to 'Assigned to' to expand related fields (Dot Walking).

9 Select **Assigned to.Department** and move it to the 'Selected' column.

10 Select **Assigned to.Email** and move it to the 'Selected' column.

11 Select **Assigned to.Manager** and move it to the 'Selected' column.

12 Click on **Save**.

13 Open an Incident form.

14 Fill the mandatory fields and set **Assigned to** to one of the imported users.

15 Verify that the Department and Email fields are automatically populated with the user's data.

6.Milestone 3: Dictionary Override

Activity 1: Make the State to 3-Moderate in Incident

The Task table (parent) has a default priority. We want the Incident table (child) to have a specific default priority of "3 - Moderate".

1 Navigate to the Incident table.

2 Open a new Incident record and observe that the **Priority** field likely defaults to 4 or 5 (inherited from Task).

3 To change this specifically for Incidents, use the **Dictionary Override** method.

4 Right-click on the **Priority** field label and select **Configure Dictionary**.

5 Scroll down to the **Dictionary Overrides** related list.

6 Click on **New**.

7 Select Table as: **Incident [incident]** (or your custom incident table extension).

8 Ensure the Column name is **priority**.

9 Check the box for **Override default value**.

10 Enter the Default Value as: **3**.

11 Click on **Submit**.

12 Open a new Incident form to test.

13 Verify that the **Priority** field now defaults to "3 - Moderate".

7.Conclusion

In this scenario, we streamlined incident management in ServiceNow by automating the import of employee data, displaying department manager information directly on incidents, and setting a custom priority default specifically for incidents. This setup saves time, ensures data accuracy, and gives incident handlers quick access to relevant information, making incident resolution faster and more efficient.